

NITI Aayog on PQC as DPI shield at India AI Impact Summit 2026



The world stands at a critical technological crossroads where the exponential growth of computing power meets the rising threat of quantum vulnerability. At the India AI Impact Summit 2026, a significant shift in national digital strategy emerged. NITI Aayog has officially positioned Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC) as a foundational “shield” for India’s world-renowned Digital Public Infrastructure. tinyurl.com/5fd6e7zh

OpenUK CEO Amanda Brock’s important advice for students on AI



During a chat at the India AI Impact Summit, OpenUK CEO Amanda Brock said, “Don’t take shortcuts. Don’t think that if you learn to vibe code, that is simply going to be the answer. You have to understand the outputs.” As per her, vibe coding is great, and having access to doing things you couldn’t do otherwise is great. But at the same time, it is also important to under if the outputs are good or not. It’s priceless wisdom that’s essential for youngsters! tinyurl.com/mtp8yrmy

What exactly is agentic commerce?

Mastercard’s Nitendra Rajput explains at India AI Impact Summit

—By Aman Rashid

To understand what it really means and how close it is to becoming mainstream, I spoke to Nitendra Rajput, Head of AI Garage at Mastercard. In this conversation, he explains how agentic commerce goes beyond payments, the challenges behind it, and why he believes India could adopt it sooner than we think.

What’s agentic commerce?

Nitendra Rajput: So, 30 years ago, if I wanted to buy something, I would go 3 kilometres, and if I did not find what I wanted within that 3 km, I would have to settle for a product available in my vicinity. If there might have been a better product at a lower price 7 km from me, I would not even have known of it. That producer who has produced that product would not know of a needy customer.

Today, if I want to buy something, I as an individual cannot figure out what all exists. So now we have agentic commerce. Agents on my behalf can swipe the entire web and find the most relevant item for me.

So that increases the matchmaking, which means the producer can now really find the specific niche customer that they want, and the customer can find a very specific product that they want without our need to be so sophisticated that we can figure out what all exists – from the most secure merchant with the best loyalty, any points



that will give it to me with the best offers. So all of that can be optimised with agentic commerce.

For someone new to the term, what does ‘agentic commerce’ actually change for the user compared to UPI or saved cards today?

Nitendra Rajput: So agentic commerce lets you do commerce, which means commerce is not just payment, as you

said. Whether it is UPI or saved cards, that’s the payments part of it. Before you come to payments, you need to figure out what needs to be bought.

There are so many options. What is most relevant for me? For that, I need to know the history of the user. So there is an agent that is figuring out what all exists. There’s another agent that is figuring out, oh okay, this person is a brand-conscious person versus this person is a value-for-money type of person, and so on. So based on my preferences, it can figure out what’s the most relevant thing for me.

A third agent will figure out that this thing is available at 16 different merchants. Which merchant looks the safest? Because these days a merchant can set up a shop, sell things for 80% discount, take all their card details, and vanish from the market in two days. So, is it a safe merchant? So it will identify if it is a safe merchant.

A fourth agent will identify that you have the product which is relevant for you and this is the safe merchant. So this is what all these different agents are doing, and they are now giving you a very efficient commerce experience than before. tinyurl.com/53af892p